



The First Half Term

Seven weeks with a new form, in order. Not icebreakers: the routines that make the next two years easier, set up one at a time, with a running order that does not assume you know thirty names yet.

Year 7 to 9. One routine a week for five weeks, then two weeks for the ones that did not stick. A form given thirty new rules in week one keeps none of them.

Print these

Page	What it is
Page 2	The seven weeks. What happens in each one, and what it is setting up.
Page 3	Print once. Everything the seven weeks needs, in the order you need it.
Page 4	The five routines, and the sheet you fill in as the half term goes.

Four things worth knowing first

	Why
Names first, and out loud	You are not building a community in week one. You are learning thirty names and letting them learn each other's, so everything in week one is built to get names said aloud by somebody who is not you.
The routine is the relationship	A form that knows exactly how the morning goes has ten spare minutes in it. Those ten minutes are where the pastoral work actually happens, and you cannot get them any other way.
Week four is the wobble	The friendships made in week one start coming apart in week four. That is normal for a Year 7 form, not a failure of week one, and it is on page two so that it does not surprise you.
Finish what you started	Everything begun in week one is closed in week seven. A form learns more from one thing being finished than from six being started.

By half term the aim is not that they like each other. It is that the morning runs itself, and that you know which three you have not really spoken to.





The seven weeks

Year 7 to 9. One new thing a week, and everything started in week one is closed in week seven.

Week	What happens	What it is setting up
Week 1	The Two-Minute Interview on the first morning, then The Register Reply from day two. Start By Half Term the same week: one sheet each, begun now, finished in week seven.	How we come in, and how we answer the register.
Week 2	Today I Will, every morning. Before you start, ask two students about yesterday's.	That you follow things up. This is the week they find out whether you do.
Week 3	The board goes up empty and the form fills it: the Display Board Pack, and the Small Wins Board beside it.	That the room belongs to them rather than to you.
Week 4	The wobble. Conversation Starters for the quiet corner, Tell Me Later and its box on the wall, and The Repair Sheet in the drawer before you need it.	That falling out is normal here, and that there is a way back from it.
Week 5	Noticed This Week, two minutes on a Friday. Praise Postcards go in the drawer the same week.	That being noticed here is ordinary rather than a prize.
Week 6	Your first proper round of one-to-ones. The Check-In Record Sheet says who you have not spoken to; The Quiet Word is the five minutes itself.	That a quiet word is a normal thing that happens, not a sign of trouble.
Week 7	By Half Term, closed, with the sheet they started in week one. Then whichever routine did not stick, once each.	That things get finished.

If your school runs a whole-school induction in the first week, start this in week two and let it finish the half term. The order matters more than the dates.





Print once

Everything the seven weeks asks for, in the order it is needed, so the trip to the photocopier happens once. All of it is free on thepastoralguide.com.

What	When you need it	How many
Two-Minute Interview	The first morning	One set of cards, cut once
The Register Reply	From day two	One sheet, for you
By Half Term	Week one, closed in week seven	One per student
Display Board Pack	Week three	One set
Small Wins Board	Week three	One set
Conversation Starters	Week four onwards	One set of cards, cut once
Tell Me Later	Week four onwards	A stack of slips, and a box
The Repair Sheet	In the drawer from week four	Ten to start with
Noticed This Week	Fridays from week five	One sheet, for you
Praise Postcards	In the drawer from week five	A stack of twenty
Check-In Record Sheet	Week six, then weekly	One, or use the spreadsheet
The Quiet Word	Week six	One for you, and cut the lanyard card out

Tick them off as they come out of the printer. Everything on this list is print once and keep, apart from the sheets that say one per student.





The five routines

What should be running without you by half term, how each one is set, and the thing that tells you it has stuck.

The routine	How it is set	How you know it has stuck
Coming in	Same door, same start, bags down before anything else. Say it out loud every morning for a fortnight and then stop saying it.	They do it while you are still getting your laptop open.
The register	The Register Reply from day two, and the question changes daily. It costs no time because the register was happening anyway.	They are waiting for the question before you have asked it.
The board	Put it up empty in week three and do not fill it yourself. Two minutes on a Friday, every Friday.	Something appears on it that you did not put there.
The quiet word	One or two a week from week six, in the same place each time, five minutes, and always finishing on a named day.	Somebody asks you for one.
The ending	The last thirty seconds of registration are the same every day: one sentence about the day ahead, and then out.	The room goes quiet for it without being asked.

As you go

Week	What you set up	What did not stick
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		

